

1. Which is the **BEST WAY** to write the underlined portion of this sentence?

However, their VCR kept them from missing their favorite primetime shows.

A. keepes

B. keeps

C. hard kept

D. keeped

2. Which is the **BEST WAY** to write the underlined portion of this sentence?

A person should keep in mind some basic safety rules when you are deciding whether or not to use a fire extinguisher.

A. rules you decide

B. rules when you decided

C. rules you are deciding

D. rules when deciding

3. What correction should be made to this sentence?

Most State tourism departments and some travel agencies have bed and breakfast listings.

A. Insert a comma after agencies

B. Change have to has

C. Change tourism to Tourism

D. Change State to state

4. What correction should be made to this sentence?

Recently, educators exammined the effectiveness of computer instruction in schools.

A. Replace educators with educator's

B. Change the spelling of exammined to examined

C. Change schools to Schools

D. Replace computer with computer's

5. Which is the **BEST WAY** to write the underlined portion of this sentence?

However, if a fire extinguisher is handy, a quick-thinking person often can use them to put out a small fire.

A. They

B. Him

C. Them

D. It

6. What correction should be made to this sentence?

First-borns often pattern their behavior after they're parents and other adults.

A. Replace their to they're

B. Change pattern to patterned

C. Replace they're to their

D. No correction is necessary

7. What correction should be made to this sentence?

Most fire-related death's result from household fires; yet many people do not have fire extinguishers in their homes.

A. Remove the comma after fires

B. Change result to results

C. Change have to has

D. Replace death's with deaths

8. What correction should be made to this sentence?

One of their theories is that the first child receives more of the parents' attention than other children so first-borns tend to be more intellectual.

A. Change is to are

B. Insert a comma after children

C. Change parents' to parent's

D. Change theories to theory's

9. Which is the **BEST WAY** to write the underlined portion of this sentence?

The hosts also benefit from running such a business because they can stay at home, make money, and meeting a variety of people.

A. Get to meet

B. To meet

C. And meet

D. And be meeting

10. Which is the **BEST WAY** to write the underlined portion of this sentence?

The studies revealing that, for various reasons, girls spent less time working with computers' than boys.

A. Revealing studies

B. Studies revealed

C. Studies' revelations

D. Studies will reveal

11. Which is the **BEST WAY** to write the underlined' portion of this sentence?

Recently psychologists have been researching birth order, their research suggests that personality and intelligence are based partly on where a child ranks in the family.

A. Order. Their

B. Order and their

C. Order, or their

D. Order their

12. Which is the **BEST WAY** to write the underlined portion of this sentence?

There is smoke detectors in many homes to warn residents of a fire, but fire extinguishers can

actually help people fight fires.

- A. They're is
- B. Their is
- C. Their are
- D. There are**

13. Which is the **BEST WAY** to write the underlined portion of this sentence?

Researchers also speculate that some teachers might have 'given boys more computer time because parents and teachers expected, boys to need computers for future careers.

- A. Will expect**
- B. Expected
- C. Will have expected
- D. Expecting

14. What correction should be made to this sentence?

Buying a fire extinguisher knowing how to use it, and placing it in a location familiar to all family members can help protect families against fire.

- A. Insert a comma after extinguisher**
- B. Change the spelling of families to familys
- C. Change placing to place
- D. Insert a comma after help

15. Which is the **BEST WAY** to write the underlined portion of this sentence?

Many viewers taped shows to watch later.

- A. Tapped
- B. Had taped**
- C. Tape
- D. Had tapped

16. What is meant by **LAST DITCH** in this sentence?

The aged bishop was prepared to fight to the last ditch to defend his good name.

- A. One's last courage
- B. One's last strategy
- C. One's last hope
- D. One's last defense**

17. Which word in the passage does **NOT** require a change in pitch to show confidence?

"I am the master of my fate, I am the captain of my soul."

- A. Am**
- B. Captain
- C. Master
- D. Fate

18. Which word is read on a high note to describe the kind of day?

This is a cold day.

- A. Is
- B. CoId**
- C. Day
- D. This

19. Which verb in the sentence is pronounced with the ending as [d]?

They laughed and joked as they walked and played.

- A. Joked
- B. Laughed
- C. Walked
- D. Played**

20. What is meant by the expression **TO GET BLOOD OUT OF A STONE** in these sentences?

Geraldo has owed me fifty thousand pesos for over a year now. I've asked him for it on several occasions, but it's like trying to get blood out of a stone.

A. Something is impossible.

B. Someone refuses to cooperate.

C. Someone is willing to give what is asked.

D. Someone wants revenge.

21. What is meant by **TWO PINS** in this sentence?

For two pins I could have hit him on the nose.

A. A second course of action

B. Without much persuading

C. The second chance

D. Have a second alternative choice

22. What is meant by **AT SIXES AND SEVENS** in this sentence?

We moved into the house last week, but I'm afraid everything, is still at sixes and sevens.

A. The things have not been shipped.

B. In a state of confusion

C. In an orderly manner

D. The boxes are still intact

23. Which word ends with [S] pronounced [Z]?

A. Maps

B. Jakes

C. Laughs

D. Buys

24. What is meant by **SOFT OPTION** in these sentences?

Rebecca realized that if she stayed in her present job it would mean competing with an envious rival. Leaving the company would probably be a soft option.

- A. An action that is difficult to take
- B. An action that is not agreeable
- C. An action that is easier.**
- D. An action that is weakly funded

25. Which word contains the voiced Th?

- A. Thank
- B. These
- C. Think**
- D. Thing

26. To gain the attention of the audience, the trick is _____?

- A. start low, speak hurriedly
- B. start high, speak loudly**
- C. start high, speak rapidly
- D. start low, speak slowly

27. Which word contains the [ae] sound?

- A. Carriage
- B. Cabin
- C. Caste**
- D. Can

28. Which of the following words **DOES NOT** contain the [voiceless th]?

- A. Mouth

B. Breath

C. Teeth

D. Health

29. Which pitch is used for the word **STRANGE**?

What a strange story!

A. 3

B. 2

C. 4

D. 1

30. What do the following lines **CONVEY**?

*Midnight, not a sound from the pavement.
Has the moon lost her memory?
She is smiling alone.
In the lamp light the withered leaves
Collect at my feet
And the wind begins to moan*

A. Confusion

B. Optimism

C. Loneliness

D. Eagerness

31. What is the mood of these lines?

*Daylight, I must wait for the sunrise
I must think of a new life
And I mustn't give in.
When the dawn comes
tonight will be a memory, too
And a new day will begin.*

A. Afraid

B. Sarcastic

C. Depressed

D. Hopeful

32. What is suggested in the opening line?

June 13, 1986 - they came from all over America - 200,000 heroes strong, with their families.

A. The writer holds great admiration for the veterans

B. The writer was a veteran of the war

C. The writer is opposed to the Vietnam War

D. The writer is a flag-waving patriot

33. Carl Sundburg wrote "*Jazz Fantasia*" which has for its first stanza:

*Drum on your drums, batter on your banjos, sob on the long cool winding saxophones.
Go to it, O jazzmen.*

Which words illustrate alliteration?

A. Batter and banjos

B. Long and cool

C. Sob and winding

D. To and it

34. Which of the following lines is a simile?

A. "Holding wonder like a cup"

B. "Life has loneliness to sell"

C. "Eyes that love you, arms that hold"

D. "Buy it and never count the cost"

35. The stanza below is taken from "*Barter*" by Sara Teasdale.

*Life has loneliness to sell,
Music like a curve of gold,*

*Scent of pine trees in the rain,
Eyes that love you, arms that hold,
And for your spirit's still delight,
Holy thoughts that star the night.*

To what does Teasdale compare music?

A. The scent of pine trees

B. A curve of gold

C. Eyes that love

D. The rain